difficult revolutionary, and that made him even more of a revolutionary," Guevara stated. "Simpletons are not revolutionaries, even less those who believe they are."[52]

Minister of Culture Armando Hart also made statements mitigating – or elaborating upon – Raúl's words at the presentation of the next issue of *Contracorriente*, stating that the Ministry of Culture must "provide a space for dialogue on the complexities of society."[53]

A new issue of *Temas*, a journal that CEA members had collaborated closely with, also came out undisturbed after Raúl's speech. The issue included the essay by CEA researcher Hugo Azcuy – who suffered a fatal heart attack the day after the speech was made – on the nature of "civil society" in Cuba. The free publication of *Temas* led some to believe that Raúl's speech should not be seen as a sign of a new intellectual closing in Cuba.

In fact some sources interpreted Raúl's speech as a *call* for critical debate rather than an attempt to silence it. By focusing on aspects of the economic opening that had not been officially acknowledged and discussed openly until now – aspects like prostitution, inequality, and corruption – the speech opened some space for public debate on these issues.[54]

Notes

1 The dollar stores operated on the principle of a 140 percent markup on all items sold. See Eckstein, "Dollarization and its Discontents," p. 320.

2 Eckstein, "Dollarization and its Discontents, p. 313.

3 Dilla Alfonso, "Cuba: The Changing Scenarios of Governability," p. 65.

4 Enríquez, "Economic Reform and Repeasantization," p. 204.

5 Corrales, "The Gatekeeper State," p. 50. Uriarte says 73 percent were employed in the state sector in 2000 (Uriarte, "Social Policy Responses").

6 Díaz-Briquets and Pérez-López, *Corruption in Cuba*, p. 97.